LOCK IT DOWN: PASSWORD SECURITY

Cybersecurity Awareness Guide | Commonwealth Bank Staff Security Guidelines

81%
Of corporate data breaches are caused by weak or stolen passwords.

4 Words
ACSC recommends passphrases with 4+ random words over complex short passwords.

2FA / MFA
Blocks up to 99% of automated credential harvesting attacks.

ACSC Best Practice: Use Passphrases, Not Passwords

🔑 What is a Passphrase?

The Australian Cyber Security Centre (ACSC) recommends using **passphrases** instead of traditional passwords. A passphrase uses four or more random words linked together.

```
purple-koala-laptop-sunset!
```

Length = Security! Longer passphrases are exponentially harder for hackers to crack.

🛡️ Password Management Tips

- **Use an Approved Password Manager:** Store complex, unique passwords securely rather than writing them down or reusing them.
- **Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Always use your security key or authenticator app when logging into enterprise tools.
- **Never Reuse Credentials:** Never use your CBA corporate password for personal accounts (social media, banking, shopping).

Essential Rules for CBA Staff

✅ DO THIS

- Make passphrases at least 14+ characters long.
- Use numbers, capital letters, and symbols.
- Report suspicious login prompts or unexpected MFA requests to the Security Operations Center (SOC) immediately.

❌ AVOID THIS

- Never share passwords with colleagues or IT support.
- Never save credentials in web browser popups.
- Avoid obvious personal details (e.g., birth dates, family names, or "CBA2026!").